et j'aimerais que le fantôme soit toi

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by argentskyflower

Summary

There’s a ghost in her bathroom.

Edit: 27/08/2025 reupload due to previous account being accidentally deleted

Notes

Hey, it's me! I'm not dead!

See the end of the work for more notes

There’s a ghost in her bathroom.

When Nathalie is done seeing Adrien off to bed, after finishing off some last-minute tasks regarding the company and the house, she retreats to her bedroom to get ready for bed. Her tablet is already set up in its charging station and there's nothing left to do but to take a soothing bath, letting the stresses of the day fall off her shoulder as she relaxes in the warm water.

The mirror isn’t quite facing the bathtub; it’s at the perfect angle for her to glance up and see who could be in the doorway of her bathroom. Having always been something of a neat freak, Nathalie prides herself on having a bathroom that hides most of her bottles and other hygiene supplies. A solid vanity with an undercounter cabinet, a small closed shelf above the seat, minor things that make the eyes focus less on the contents and more into the interior design of the bathroom. Which, given that the former master of this house is one Gabriel Agreste, means quite a lot in terms of luxurious design.

She has lived in this house for years and that means being intimately acquainted with every nook and cranny of her bathroom, the way the light shines on every polished surface, the way the steam wafts through the tiny space and through the well-hidden vents, the flash of silver eyes from behind the bath curtain—

Nathalie pauses. Blinks. Her neck slowly, deliberately, turns from an idle tilt towards the mirror to a more upright cant, alertness suffusing her body like a tap being opened, fingers curling around the edge of the bathtub.

No one’s there.

Of course there isn’t, why wouldn’t there be?

It’s only her and Adrien left in the house by now.

She’d made sure the gates and doors were locked and that all security systems, especially those concerning privacy, were running high (except of course, for Adrien’s room, for *obvious* reasons). In the days after Gabriel’s…demise, she’d handled the journalists and nosy busybodies with all the grace of a bowling ball hitting the pins in a bowling alley. More than one rag had called her unflattering names and made various aspersions towards her and the Agrestes, that the lawyers on her speed dial had to be sending their grandchildren to private lycée with how much she paid them to deal with it.

There is absolutely no way someone could have entered the mansion unless…

Nathalie’s eyes flicker towards her phone. It’s not vibrating with an akuma alert, so if it’s an akuma then it’s either too sneaky for the Ladyblog to sound the alarm or it’s still too early for the attack. Unlikely, in both cases: her contacts would have alerted her by now if something did happen even without an official alert over the city.

Which leaves her with one final conclusion: that she's being paranoid. Again.

She settles back into the bath with a little hum that could almost be classified as sullen if it didn't come from a place of true self-disdain. Paranoia is an expected aftereffect of everything that happened recently, of course—if she ever bothered listening to her therapist about it. Already she's more than halfway to giving up on her current one and looking for a new one; she'd never been very open to begin with and the forced cheer of her current therapist had begun to make her teeth ache. That, and the fact that even in the one place she needed to be honest to heal, *she is still lying* .

After all, only she and Ladybug know the truth of what really happened to Gabriel Agreste.

As she settles back into the bathtub, the veneer of calm that she'd had when she came in was no longer anywhere to be found. Instead, Nathalie finds her eyes wandering the bathroom, looking a little too long at every marginally unlit nook and cranny, the blind spots weighing on her shoulders like a too-heavy coat. She feels too exposed, splayed out like this in the water with not even her glasses to sharpen her vision, and the discomfort of being vulnerable propels her body up and away from the now cold bathwater.

Nathalie reaches first for her glasses, wiping the fog away from the glasses before putting them on. Blue eyes survey her bathroom with a critical air, and it's impossible to discern whether it is satisfaction or disappointment she feels when she confirms that she is indeed alone.

The cooler air streaming from the gap between her bedroom and the bathroom door rises up along her legs and creates goosebumps in their wake; she shifts her feet but makes no other move. The water from her skin drops onto the bathroom mat and her wet hair sticks to her neck and back but she does not grab the towel. She leans against the porcelain vanity counter, her spine digging into the edge while her arms hang loosely by her side.

Nathalie should have let it go. She should have grabbed the towel, dried herself off, went out into her closet to dress herself and get ready for bed. But there's a feeling at the bottom of her stomach and the hairs on the back of her arms haven't settled down yet. She's certain that she's alone, and yet…

"Hello?"

Her voice echoes out into the bathroom, bouncing off the tiles and the water in the bathtub and her own beating heart which now sounds so impossibly loud in her ears.

Silence answers her.

Nathalie waits.

The tiniest of breaths gusts across her ear. A faint scent of sandalwood cuts through the steamy air. Goosebumps erupt along her arm as the light pressure of invisible fingertips

push against moist skin.

She takes a deep breath.

The steam is rapidly dissipating, the cooling water unable to sustain the fog inside the bathroom, and so as the seconds tick by and her body remains immobile on the vanity counter, she can see the way the steam appears to warp around a figure *directly in front of her* .

She releases the breath in a rapid gust of air that does nothing to dissipate the figure's form, barely visible, features too formless to identify, yet it towers over her in a visage whose full presence can only be seen in the way the steam appears to curl around every part.

Nathalie, without breaking her gaze, reaches behind her and turns on the tap for hot water. Almost immediately, fresh steam drifts from the open tap joins the existing fog in the bathroom. The sound of running water is not enough to drown the gradual silence of the vents as the dial on the far side of the bathroom turns on its own to a closing stop.

There can be no mistaking the identity of this being.

She swallows. "What do you want?"

The pressure of invisible fingertips that lingered on her arm start a meandering journey downward from her arm all the way to her hand, her own fingers being lifted without input from her until the spaces between her fingers are filled with something not quite tangible and yet not visible either, only the barest hint of a presence to suggest that something is currently holding her hand.

She curls her fingers in, and waits.

Silver flashes through the steam.

The presence eventually leaves her hand, and Nathalie is not granted the opportunity of feeling the loss before it appears once again, this time tracing the curve of her bare thigh, lingering on the divots that her support equipment had left on her skin. Nathalie breathes, and regret is an oily after-scent that she only identifies in its familiarity to her in the days Before.

This gesture is familiar too.

Like a wind-up clock, Nathalie turns on her heel to face the vanity, the movement making her joints creak and her vision to briefly spin before she steadies herself on the cold tile of the counter. The mirror shows nothing but the faintest afterimage of steam and fog avoiding a space in the rough shape of a man standing behind her, eerily recognizable and altogether too familiar from the posture alone.

The face is indistinct, and there is no sound except her own breathing, but she could almost feel the warmth of a body as the phantom leans in closer; this too, is familiar.

Ghostly hands grip the sides of her hips and she cants her lower body backwards, bracing her hands on the counter for balance and—

This is ridiculous. Here she is, Nathalie Sancoeur, with her arse out and a ghost behind her who might very well be Gabriel Agreste in the exact same position they'd first slept together, when he'd found her after a bath and fucked her against her own vanity. Neither of them had looked in the mirror and the very same oily stench of shame and regret had clung to the back of Nathalie's mouth but it had been the start of pattern, a pattern sustained by the willingness to find comfort where it would be given and comfort given too freely out of a poorly hidden desire for intimacy and affection. Gabriel is *dead* , his body torn apart by a magic that gave him no choice but to relentlessly pursue for a cure, and here she still stands, alive and pining and bitter and free and everything in between, fantasising about the presence in her bathroom as her former employer-slash-lover, when it could in fact be nothing but the delusions of a lonely woman—

"Ah!" the sounds cracks through the air as something hard and thick pushes inside her cunt without any warning and fuck, it should hurt but it doesn't; her walls pulsing against something that feels exactly like a cock and a telltale weight on her back and hands that wander from her hips to her torso to her breasts in that same rough, almost careless way he had always done before.

Her nipples pebble into swollen peaks in a way that she'd attribute to the steam if it weren't for the deliberate pinching and pulling and kneading of ghostly fingers on ghostly hands. Her whole body rocks back and forth with the force of his thrusts, the bulbous head of his member spreading her walls apart with rough yet consistent thrusts, and Nathalie bites back the moans threatening to spill out of her throat automatically, the way she'd always done when they did this before, when Gabriel was still alive.

Eventually, one hand leaves her breasts to quest between her legs, and there Nathalie has to grip the counter with white knuckles as the phantom toys with her clit. Her breaths come in sharp gasps for air as she twists her hips and chases her own high, closing her eyes and imagining that Gabriel is still alive, that he's here with her and not six feet under a grave that doesn't say everything that he's ever done to Paris and his own son, that he's the one huffing and groaning behind her and his heart is beating in time with her own and he's alive, alive, *alive* —!

When she comes, it's to the tiny pool of warmth in her stomach and a cunt that pulses around nothing but air. She crosses her legs, feeling too weak to keep standing straight, and catches her breath by the counter with her head down and glasses askew.

The presence is gone. There is no evidence there was ever a presence, no extra fog on a mirror, nor even through marks left on her skin. Here Nathalie barely keeps herself standing, trembling from an orgasm, her brain half-addled by steam and of the fantasy that Gabriel Agreste is somehow still alive. The lingering steam curls around her, bereft of any warmth or suggestion of a direction, and there's nothing in the bathroom but the resounding lack of anyone or anything other than herself.

She waits.

There is no answer.

When she stands, still with trembling legs, it's to grab the towel from the rack and dry what lingering droplets are on her body. Her cunt throbs as she drags the towel roughly on it; she doesn't care and continues all the way down to her legs. Then she hangs the towel back on the rack, and grabs the rag near the sink to clear the fog off the mirror. If she slows her wiping with every pass of her arm over her face as if expecting someone to appear behind her, then she is the only witness.

The mirror stays empty save for her. She averts her gaze from the tears she can see building in her own eyes.

Nathalie turns off the tap and walks over to the dial for the bathroom vents. Her hand barely trembles as she spins it all the way to full, letting the vents suck all the steam out. She pulls the plug on the bathtub and watches impassionately as the water drains. The chill of the night settles on her skin like a mantle, and she opens the bathroom door to walk back to her bedroom.

As her foot leaves the threshold of the bathroom, something brushes across her lips.

Nathalie pauses.

Then slowly, deliberately, she turns her head…and walks away.

Behind her, as her fingers flick the light switch off, silver eyes blink into existence in the half-second between the sharp click of the switch and the light going out.

It disappears only when Nathalie closes the bathroom door.

End Notes

Currently trying to warm up my writing muscles again. Yes, it's with smut, of course, what else? Let me know what you think of this story, I'd love to hear everything!

Betaed by MarysTulips

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